Fake stores imitate legitimate shops

Copied pages can persuade shoppers to pay or share personal details with a criminal.

Money lost

Personal details exposed

Familiar cues do not verify the seller

Logo + polished design

A fake store can copy both.

HTTPS

Encrypts the connection.
Does not prove the shop is legitimate.

A reassuring page can still belong to an unverified seller.

A brand name can appear inside someone else's address

brand.example-shop.test

A familiar-looking prefix

"brand" is only a subdomain.

The actual domain

example-shop.test

Parsing: tldts + Public Suffix List, including private suffixes. Fictional address.

The verdict follows explicit conditions

OBSERVED EVIDENCE	RESULT
Sensitive fields on HTTP, or a sensitive form with an HTTP destination	HIGH RISK
Covered-brand hostname resemblance + matching page identity + age < 30 days	HIGH RISK
Age < 30 days alone	REVIEW

Selected rules. The 30-day threshold is a heuristic, not a validated fraud boundary.

Local page inspection.
One optional registry lookup.

Inside the browser

Content script reads field types,
form destinations and page metadata.

650 ms debounce after relevant changes.
The extension worker evaluates the rules.

RDAP registration lookup

Sends the domain to its registry.
3.5 s timeout. Failure stays unknown.

Success cache: 24 h. Failure cache: 1 min.
The registry also sees the network address.

No entered values. Embedded frames and script-driven transfers remain unverified.

Can the warning arrive before details are entered?

Unsafe checkout

Reveal a sensitive form on HTTP.
Watch the warning become stronger.

A new independent shop

Check whether newness alone triggers a high-risk warning.

First-pass screening cannot prove legitimacy or guarantee delivery.